JPE Replication Report

2026-11-05

1 Paper Identification

ID	20200631
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Title	Developmental Meritocracy
Iteration	1

Some useful information up front:

- JPE Data and Code Availability Policy
- Step by step guidance from Data Editor for Authors
- Template README

2 Summary

In assessing compliance with our Data and Code Availability Policy, our reproducibility team has identified the following issues, which we ask you to address:

1. Data Editor's first point.
2. Data Editor's second point.

3 General

☐ Data Availability and Provenance Statements

  ☐ Statement about Rights - Part 1: Right to use the data (e.g. *did the authors lawfully obtain the data*)

- ☐ Statement about Rights - Part 2: Right to publish the data (e.g. *are human subjects involved and did permission been granted to publish their data?*)
- ☐ License for Data (optional, but recommended)
- ☐ Details on each Data Source

☐ Dataset list
☐ Computational requirements

- ☐ Software Requirements
- ☐ Controlled Randomness (as necessary)
- ☐ Memory, Runtime, and Storage Requirements

☒ Description of programs/code

- ☐ License for Code (Optional, but recommended)

☐ List of tables and programs
☐ References (Optional, but recommended)

4 High-level Description of Research Project

This research project...

☐ uses observational data.
☐ uses *confidential* observational data.
☒ uses data generated via experiment or trial by the authors (in field or lab).

- ☐ For lab experiments: The code to implement the experimental protocol (z-Tree, o-Tree etc) is included in the package.
- ☒ A PDF copy of IRB approval is contained in the package.
- ☒ A PDF document outlining the design of the experiment, including information on the selection and eligibility of participants is included.
- ☒ A PDF copy of the instructions given to participants in both original language and an English translation is included.

☐ uses data generated via survey by the authors (in field or online)

- ☐ The programs used to administer the survey (e.g. qualtrics survey file) are included.
- ☐ A PDF copy of IRB approval is contained in the package.
- ☐ A PDF of the original questionaire(s) and information on the selection and eligibility of participants is included.

☐ is a simulation study: the data are generated by an algorithm.
☐ is a numerical illustration: no data are used but code is used to produce illustrative output (tables, figures)

Note: o-Tree code is not included in the package, but on a public Github repository linked in the README.

5 Data description

5.1 Data Sources

file/name	public	private	shared with us	DOI/URL	Access described	cited readme	cited paper
data/dataAG.csv	yes	no	yes	Not required	yes	no	no
data/dataAL.csv	yes	no	yes	Not required	yes	no	no
data/dataALsmall.csv	yes	no	yes	Not required	yes	no	no

6 Requirements

- ☒ README is in TXT, MD, or PDF format
- ☒ README is accessible at the root of the package (not inside a folder)
- ☐ Title conforms to guidance (starts with "Data and Code for: Title of Paper" or "Code for: Title of Paper", is properly capitalized)
- ☐ Authors (with affiliations) are listed in the same order as on the paper

6.1 Stated Requirements

- ☒ No requirements specified
- ☐ Software Requirements specified as follows:
  - Software 1
  - Software 2
- ☐ Computational Requirements specified as follows:
  - Cluster size, etc.
- ☐ Time Requirements specified as follows:
  - Length of necessary computation (hours, weeks, etc.)

☐ Requirements are complete.

For missing requirements, see the list of required changes in Section 9

7 Analyzing Data and Code Files

7.1 Secrets Scan

No credentials detected.

7.2 Potential Personal Identifiable Information (PII)

We found the following instances of potentially personally identifying information. This may be completely legitimate but might be worth checking. *As a reminder, privacy legislation in many countries (e.g. GDPR in EU) prohibits the dissemination of personal identifiable information without prior (and documented) consent of individuals.* If indeed you want to publish such information with your replication package, you should probably have obtained IRB approval for this - please check!

Summary:

- Data files with PII indicators: 7
- Variables flagged in data: 28
- Code files with PII references: 19
- PII references in code: 407

7.2.1 Summary of Flagged Files

File Type	File	Variables/References	PII Categories
Data	`dataAG.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Data	`dataAL.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Data	`dataALsmall.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Data	`dataLL.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Data	`dataLLsmall.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Data	`dataME.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Data	`dataMEsmall.csv`	4	loc, gender, birth
Code	`Code.R`	346	name, lat, school, birth, gender, loc, location, coord, lname, son, second, child, block, lon

File Type	File	Variables/References	PII Categories
Code	Table16.tex	1	loc, location
Code	Table17.tex	1	loc, location
Code	Table2.tex	1	loc, location
Code	Table20.tex	2	lon
Code	Table21.tex	2	lon
Code	Table3.tex	1	loc, location
Code	Table4.tex	1	loc, location
Code	revised ms.tex	36	name, url, lat, lon, school, city, gender, loc, location, son, child, address, second, social, birth
Code	summary_table.tex	2	lat, school
Code	table10.tex	1	loc, location
Code	table11.tex	1	loc, location
Code	table12.tex	1	loc, location

See Appendix for detailed listing of all flagged instances.

7.2.2 File Paths Report

Generated on 2026-10-22T10:07:58.286

Warning: Our search on file path types is imperfect and incurs both type 1 and type 2 errors. We aim to strike a reasonable balance between both. The below table is therefore only indicative. Detailed listings can be found in the appendix to this report.

In this table we analyse all files which contain source code (not data and documentation), and we report the grand total of each type of filepath we encountered.

Please check and replace any `windows` filepaths with unix compliant paths, insofar as this is possible in your setup. (Notice that `STATA` allows `/` to be a filepath separator on a windows platform, hence this is a requirement for *all* `STATA` applications.)

Files Analyzed	Windows Paths	Unix Paths	Mixed Paths	Drive Letters (`C:\` etc)
44	0	0	2	0

7.2.3 Duplicate Files Report

We found the following duplicate files:

Filename	Size (MB)	Checksum (MD5)
/__MACOSX/Replication Package/Code/._.DS_Store	0.0	8ec81157df48d4a559147718111d98c40c416306
/__MACOSX/Replication Package/Paper/._.DS_Store	0.0	8ec81157df48d4a559147718111d98c40c416306
/__MACOSX/Replication Package/Paper/Figs/._.DS_Store	0.0	8ec81157df48d4a559147718111d98c40c416306
/__MACOSX/Replication Package/data/._.DS_Store	0.0	8ec81157df48d4a559147718111d98c40c416306
/Replication Package/Documentation/.DS_Store	0.01	df2fbeb1400acda0909a32c1cf6bf492f1121e07
/Replication Package/Paper/Figs_appC/personality4.png	0.76	adef473b9026d8c59237efbb36f781ca7897ae16

7.2.4 Zero Size Files Report

We did not find any zero sized files.

7.2.5 Large Files Report

We did not find any files larger than 100MB.

7.3 Code description

All figures produced by the only source file, Code.R. Some figures only contain examples and/or qualitative information about the lab trial, so they were not replicated. One table of summary statistics could not be identifed in the source code (table 8).

cloc	github.com/AlDanial/cloc v 2.02 T=0.10 s (314.8 files/s, 114429.2 lines/s)

Language	files	blank	comment	code
TeX	22	779	21	5700
CSV	7	0	0	2306
R	1	345	167	1588
SUM:	30	1124	188	9594

7.4 Code Quality

7.4.1 R

[ADVISORY] `filter(` call not preceded by a comment within 2 lines — consider adding a comment explaining the criterion. (Code.R, line 617) → filter(age2 > 6)

[ADVISORY] `filter(` call not preceded by a comment within 2 lines — consider adding a comment explaining the criterion. (Code.R, line 1513) → filter(age2 > 6)

[ADVISORY] `merge()` called without explicit `all=`, `all.x=`, or `all.y=` argument — defaults to inner join, which may silently drop rows. (Code.R, line 1709) → m <- merge(d, p, by = "ClientID")

7.5 LLM API Usage & Reproducibility

No LLM API usage detected.

☒ The replication package contains a "main" or "master" file(s) which calls all other auxiliary programs.

NOTE: In-text numbers that reference numbers in tables do not need to be listed. Only in-text numbers that correspond to no table or figure need to be listed.

7.6 Computing Environment of the Replicator

- SSPCloud instance, RStudio image with 16Gb of memory running Debian 13.1 on Intel Xeon Gold 6140 @2.3Ghz, 18 physical cores.
- RStudio (R version 4.6.1)

8 Replication

- Uploaded code and data to SSP server instance
- Ran `Code.R`
- Failed while installing libraries:

```
> library(texreg)
  Error in library(texreg) : there is no package called `texreg`
```

- Followed the prompt offering to install missing packages
- Ran code again
- Failed while trying to save an output file:

```
In file(con, "w")
  cannot open file '../Paper/Figs/Table2.tex': No such file or directory
```

- Created directory `Figs` inside `Paper`, and ran code again. Note that `Figs` was present in the replication package, this error is due to my S3 client which does not upload empty directories to the remote server.
- Code ran to completion.

9 Findings

9.1 Missing Requirements

☒ Software Requirements

- ☒ R
  - ☒ Version
    - R packages go here
- ☒ Operating system
  - ☒ Version

☒ Computational Requirements specified as follows:

- No computational requirements specified

☒ Time Requirements

- No time requirements specified

[REQUIRED] Please amend README to contain complete requirements.

You can copy the section above, amended if necessary.

9.2 Data Preparation Code

There is no data preparation code, all code is in a single master file `Code.R`.

9.3 Tables and Figures

Figure/Table #	Program	Line Number	Reproduced?	File name
Figure 1	Not specified	Not specified	No (descriptive data)	No file
Figure 2	Not specified	Not specified	No (descriptive data)	No file
Figure 3	Not specified	Not specified	No (descriptive data)	No file
Table 1	Not specified	Not specified	No (descriptive data)	No file
Table 2	Code.R	311	Yes	table2.tex
Figure 4	Code.R	350	Yes	payments.pdf, payments1.pdf, paymentsCond.pdf, paymentsCond1.pdf
Table 3	Code.R	579	Yes	table3.tex
Figure 5	Code.R	642	Yes	redistribution1.pdf, addition1.pdf
Table 4	Code.R	582	Yes	table4.tex
Figure 6	Code.R	644	Yes	redistribution.pdf, addition.pdf
Table 4	Code.R	795	Yes	table5.tex
Figure 7	Code.R	844	Yes	fig-big5-score.pdf,fig-tom-dist.pdf
Table 6	Code.R	1054	Yes	table6.tex

Figure/Table #	Program	Line Number	Reproduced?	File name
Table 7	Not specified	Not specified	No (descriptive data)	No file
Figure 8	Not specified	Not specified	No (descriptive data)	No file
Table 8	Not specified	Not specified	No	No file
Table 9	Code.R	1255	Yes	table9.tex
Table 10	Code.R	1342	Yes	table10.tex
Table 11	Code.R	1342	Yes	table11.tex
Table 12	Code.R	1343	Yes	table12.tex
Table 13	Code.R	1344	Yes	table13.tex
Table 14	Code.R	1345	Yes	table14.tex
Table 15	Code.R	1424	Yes	table15.tex
Table 16	Code.R	1530	Yes	Table16.tex
Figure 9	Code.R	1533	Yes	figure9.pdf
Table 17	Code.R	1535	Yes	Table17.tex
Figure 10	Code.R	1538	Yes	figure10.pdf
Table 18	Code.R	1749	Yes	table18.tex
Table 19	Code.R	1771	Yes	table19.tex
Table 20	Code.R	1934	Yes	Table20.tex
Table 21	Code.R	1936	Yes	Table21.tex
Table 22	Code.R	2097	Yes	Table22.tex

- All reproduced figures and tables perfectly match those of the paper.
- 6 figures/tables were not reproduced due to their nature (screenshot(s) and/or descriptive information)
- 1 table of summary statistics (table 8) was not reproduced, because the code to generate it appears to be missing from source code.

9.4 In-Text Numbers

☐ In-text numbers not verified.

☒ There are no in-text numbers, or all in-text numbers stem from tables and figures.

☐ There are in-text numbers, but they are not identified in the code

9.5 Other Issues

- README is missing a lot of information. It does not contain any explicit instructions to the replicator, as well as requirements which would facilitate replication.

10 Classification

☐ full reproduction
☐ full reproduction with minor issues
☒ partial reproduction (see above)
☐ not able to reproduce most or all of the results (reasons see above)

10.1 Reason for incomplete reproducibility

☐ None.
☐ `Discrepancy in output` (either figures or numbers in tables or text differ)
☐ `Bugs in code` that were fixable by the replicator (but should be fixed in the final deposit)
☒ `Code missing`, in particular if it prevented the replicator from completing the reproducibility check

  ☐ `Data preparation code missing` should be checked if the code missing seems to be data preparation code

☐ `Code not functional` is more severe than a simple bug: it prevented the replicator from completing the reproducibility check
☐ `Software not available to replicator` may happen for a variety of reasons, but in particular (a) when the software is commercial, and the replicator does not have access to a licensed copy, or (b) the software is open-source, but a specific version required to conduct the reproducibility check is not available.
☐ `Insufficient time available to replicator` is applicable when (a) running the code would take weeks or more (b) running the code might take less time if sufficient compute resources were to be brought to bear, but no such resources can be accessed in a timely fashion (c) the replication package is very complex, and following all (manual and scripted) steps would take too long.
☐ `Data missing` is marked when data *should* be available, but was erroneously not provided, or is not accessible via the procedures described in the replication package
☐ `Data not available` is marked when data requires additional access steps, for instance purchase or application procedure.
☒ `Missing README` is marked if there is no README to guide the replicator, or the README is not in compliance with JPE requirements

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